



# Welcome to QuACK!

Week 1

9/10/2026

Nina, Alyson, & Victoria

# Today's Agenda

- Welcome & introductions
- Goals and structure of the bootcamp
- Get to know your peers
- Let's look at some real data!
- Introduction to R and data types

# Who are we?

**Nina (she/her/hers)** [nina\\_schoener@berkeley.edu](mailto:nina_schoener@berkeley.edu)

4th year PhD Student • Developmental • LCD (Srinivasan) Lab

**Alyson (she/her/hers)** [alyson\\_wong@berkeley.edu](mailto:alyson_wong@berkeley.edu)

4th year PhD Student • Developmental • BELL (Xu Lab)

**Victoria (she/her/hers)** [victoria\\_keating@berkeley.edu](mailto:victoria_keating@berkeley.edu)

7th year PhD Candidate • Developmental • LCD (Srinivasan) Lab / UC DREAMS (Eason) Lab

# Let's get to know each other!

- Your name
- What lab you're in, what your role is
- 1 recommendation (book, TV show, restaurant, cafe, artist, game...)

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# Why are we doing this?

- Coding skills are becoming increasingly more important, not just for research but for many jobs → It's a transferable skill
- Learning to code can feel really inaccessible and even scary!
  - If you feel this way, you're not alone!
- We want to help make learning R and programming feel more accessible and fun

# Why R?

R is built for working with and analyzing data frames. And that is exactly what we need!

Pointing and clicking is easy and accessible, but it has its limitations – especially when it comes to reproducibility!

Check out these sites for more information:

- [Why is R so great?](#)
- [Why R is like a relationship...](#)

From: [YaRrr! The Pirate's Guide to R](#)



# Goals for the course

- Learn foundational R and programming skills so you can learn more on your own and in your lab
  - Don't just do, **understand**!
- Feel confident in your skills moving forward
- Build an inclusive, welcoming, and supportive community around programming and data skills for people at all skill levels and from all backgrounds

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Day 1





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Day 1



Day 100



And it is always a work in progress!  
Be patient with yourself!

# Some things to keep in mind

- People are coming in with different backgrounds and experiences
- Some things we talk about may be easy for you, and others may be new
- Be open to brushing up on things you already know and supporting your peers while they learn something new!
- We have tried to make this workshop accessible and interesting for people at various different levels

# Structure of the course

## Typical class structure

1. Introduction to the skill we're covering
2. Live coding demo (interrupt us with questions!)
3. Individual practice and work on real data
4. Talk it over with peers

Instructors will come around to answer questions

5. Discussion

We will send you the materials (scripts, PDFs, and datasets) for each week before the session.

# Structure of the course

|         |       |                                                    |
|---------|-------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Week 1  | 9/10  | Intro to R & Programming                           |
| Week 2  | 9/17  | Intro to the tidyverse and data wrangling - Part 1 |
| Week 3  | 9/24  | Intro to the tidyverse and data wrangling - Part 2 |
| Week 4  | 10/1  | Intro to data visualization (ggplot) - Part 1      |
| Week 5  | 10/8  | Intro to data visualization (ggplot) - Part 2      |
| Week 6  | 10/15 | Error Messages/Review/Q&A                          |
| Week 7  | 10/22 | Intro to Basic Stats - Part 1                      |
| Week 8  | 10/29 | Intro to Basic Stats - Part 2                      |
| Week 9  | 11/5  | Putting it all together                            |
| Week 10 | 11/12 | <b>NO CLASS</b>                                    |
| Week 11 | 11/19 | Open-Science, Github & Git                         |

# Time to get started in R!

- Go to <https://tinyurl.com/quack-fall2026>
- Download and unzip the course materials
- You will see many files:
  - Two R Markdown (.rmd) files
  - A .csv file
  - Two PDF files – slides and a practice doc
  - Some other folders – ignore these for now
- Open the R Markdown file marked “starter\_code” – this is where we will code together for the first part of the session
- The .csv file contains the data we will be working with
- The practice PDF contains practice exercises for you to do during the second part of the session



# Exit Ticket

Link: <https://tinyurl.com/quack-fall2026-exit-survey>

